

Day 9 — From Ancient to Action: The Neighbourhood Walk

Module: Indic Ecology · **Band:** Middle · **Time:** 45 min (20 min walk + 25 min in-class)

Learning objective

Students conduct a 15-minute observation walk on or near the school campus, record one specific ecological observation, and draft a single concrete action they will lead — anchored on one Indic principle.

Materials

- Each pair's project plan from yesterday
- Notebook + pen
- A printed observation sheet (see [activities/activity-02-eco-walk.md](#))
- Permission slip already on file for off-campus walk (only if leaving campus; on-campus is fine without)
- Smartphone with camera if available (one per pair maximum, used only for documentation, not for general phone use)

Vocabulary

(All previous; no new terms today. Today is application.)

Lesson flow

Pre-walk briefing (10 min — in class)

1. **Review the project plan paragraph.** Each pair confirms:
 - Their anchor Indic principle.
 - Their walk objective.
 - Their format (poster / 2-min audio / action plan).
2. **Walk rules.**
 - Pairs stay together. No solo walkers.
 - 15 minutes. The teacher's timer is final.
 - Phones in pocket except for one documentation photo per pair.
 - One specific observation, written down on the sheet.
 - Walk in silence for the first 5 minutes. Talk only after.
3. **What “observation” means here.**
 -  Bad: “*There is pollution.*”

-  Good: “At the south gate, between 8:00 and 8:15, twelve cars idled with engines running. The exhaust collected in the corner where the watchman sits.”

Specificity makes the action possible.

The walk (15 min)

- Pairs leave together with their sheet.
- Teacher walks a perimeter to monitor; no specific guidance during the walk.
- Pairs come back to the classroom at 25 min mark.

Post-walk action drafting (15 min — in class)

1. **Each pair writes — on the sheet — their action plan.** Three lines:
 - **What we observed** (specific, with time and place).
 - **Which Indic principle this connects to** (one of the four).
 - **What action we will lead** (specific, doable in the next 14 days).
2. **Action criteria.** An action is acceptable if:
 - It is specific (names a thing to do, a person to talk to, a place to fix).
 - It can be done within 14 days.
 - The pair can actually do it themselves (no “the government should…”).
3. **Examples of acceptable actions:**

Observation	Principle	Action
Twelve idling cars at pick-up	<i>Yajña</i> — give back to <i>vāyu</i>	A hand-painted “Engine OFF While Parked” sign at the gate
A leaking tap at the science block	<i>Iṣopaniṣad</i> — don’t grab	Report to admin + remind every day until fixed
A dust-heavy corner with no green	<i>Ṛthivī Sūkta</i> — Earth as mother	Plant two saplings + water for 2 weeks
A pile of plastic at the canteen	<i>Vasudhaiva kuṭumbakam</i> — one family	Set up one labelled segregation bin + 1 week of monitoring

4. **Examples of unacceptable actions:**
 - “Stop climate change.” (Too vague.)
 - “Plant 1 lakh trees.” (Not doable in 14 days.)
 - “The government should ban diesel.” (Not the pair’s action.)

Wrap-up (5 min)

- Each pair reads ONE line of their action plan aloud — the action sentence.
- Teacher acknowledges each with a short response (clarify, narrow, encourage).

- Tomorrow: 3-minute pitch + summative quiz.

Student-facing content

The walk has three rules: 1. Stay with your partner. 2. Write down one specific observation — with time and place. 3. Draft one specific action you can actually do.

The action criteria: - Specific (says exactly what you'll do). - Doable in 14 days. - Done by you, not “by someone.”

The Indic principle anchors your *why*. The observation anchors your *what*. The action is the actual *yajña*.

Homework

- Finalise your pitch:
 - 3 minutes max.
 - Both partners speak.
 - Open with the principle. Show the observation. End with the action.
- Bring your artefact (poster / audio file on a device / printed plan).

Differentiation

- **One tier up:** Add a “measurement” to your action — how will you know whether it worked? (E.g. “*By Day 14, 5 fewer cars idling at pick-up.*”) Measured actions are stronger.
- **One tier down:** Stick to one observation and one action. Skip the measurement. The principle + observation + action is enough.

Teacher notes

- Some pairs will plan an action they can't actually do. Push back kindly during the post-walk drafting. “Who specifically will you talk to? When?”
- Some pairs will plan an action that is too large to do in 14 days. Cut it. “What's the smallest version of this you can do this week?” The 14-day frame is non-negotiable; the rubric on Day 10 reflects this.
- The “engine off” sign is the most common student action. Encourage variation — water saving, food waste, biodiversity (a pollinator-friendly corner), noise reduction. Module 13 is about the full five elements, not just air.
- If the school is in a context where an outdoor walk isn't feasible (rain, unsafe neighbourhood), do a “windows and corridors” walk inside the building. Same rules.

Citation(s) used in this lesson

- None new; today's anchor is the four principles already cited (Days 1, 5, 6, 7).